

company, we have significant support from the authorities. Apart from the government, enterprises in India are going global, and in a fiercely competitive environment, organisations look for tremendous cost-effectiveness, as well as flexibility and reliability as the key deciding factors when it comes to technology adoption. Open source is the perfect choice to help enterprises overcome all such hurdles.

Q What are the major challenges for an open source company like SUSE to operate profitably in the Indian market?

Today, the major challenge that an open source organisation faces in India is the unavailability of skilled resources. Open source organisations such as SUSE have been making huge efforts to popularise the adoption of open source right from the elementary school to a higher level of educations. There are a lot of universities, school boards and technical education centres nowadays that are adopting open source education as a part of their ICT curriculum.

Q How do you overcome those challenges?

SUSE invests heavily in developing course content on cutting-edge new technologies. There are online academies as well as on-demand training available to master these newer technologies. On top of these, YouTube releases by experts help individuals to master the available technologies.

There is a unique programme wherein SUSE enables academic institutions to subscribe to all its course materials at zero cost. These materials are regularly updated. Also, students and individuals can get themselves certified on technologies like OpenStack and software defined storage.

Q What are your prime strategies to enable developer engagement around your offerings?

We have SUSE Studio that allows developers to build applications on

open source technologies. Recently, the company has also released a Container-as-a-Service (CaaS) to cater to the developer community. The new model is the way forward for DevOps across India.

Also, SUSE encourages the developer community by bringing in a straightforward ISV (independent software vendor) certification process, which allows ISVs to get their products certified easily on SUSE. As a community programme, Open SUSE is a huge success.

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In India, we are growing by double digits, and with open source at the heart of the Indian government's IT Policy, we are expanding at a significant rate.
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Q Do you believe community support is important to grow an open source product?

Indeed it is! Open source communities encourage innovation through collaboration. They provide a platform for developers to keep improving the programs or code in line with the latest technological advancements.

Without open source, many of the technologies we enjoy today would never have been developed or would be restricted from being widely used because of the patent law. But thanks to open source communities, those technologies have developed at a breakneck pace over the past few decades.

Q How do you manage to market the entire SUSE portfolio to Indian customers?

We are a 100 per cent channel-driven company, and our partners are the key to our success. They are valued the most within the organisation. We have separate teams for managing large, medium and small channels. We also maintain a

well-defined tiering system among our channels and have a wide network of both Tier-1 and Tier-2 to cater to the needs of various markets and customers across India. Recently, we collaborated with 70-80 partners, and it is a constantly growing network in the country. Channel expansion is of great strategic importance to our business.

Q What makes SUSE Linux a distinct option in the growing space of open source distributions?

SUSE Linux is reliable, highly scalable and includes cutting-edge technology. Moreover, it comes with best-in-class support.

Q Do Indian enterprises view Linux as a part of their IT deployments nowadays? Is there any difference from the past?

The acceptance of open source among Indian enterprises has been remarkable. Looking back at Linux adoption just five years ago — almost 60 per cent of servers were on proprietary OSs, and only 35 per cent used to be on Linux in the data centre space. Now, the mix has changed dramatically, and Linux has taken over proprietary systems.

In the computing space, organisations are looking at an alternative option, because most of the applications are Web enabled and need a browser to access them. They do not see the need to pay for a browser. Application software like LibreOffice, which is a complete office suite, does everything that Microsoft Office does. This is exactly why large customers like the government of India have consciously decided to embrace open source. Neither government organisations nor enterprises want vendor lock-in. Also, with a proprietary system, you lose the freedom of choice.

Q What are the key drivers enhancing Linux adoption in developing markets like India?

Adoption of OpenStack Cloud and software defined storage (SDS) are the most disruptive technology trends in the